

conditions of the third class, and to provide adequate training and employment opportunities to Indians for higher positions in the railway service. It recommended the construction of branch lines, which were managed by their main lines, with separate branch line companies to be formed only if the Government was unable or disinclined to provide funds for these. The members also urged for a commission to examine the gauge question.

The Acworth Committee channelized much of the public sentiments in its report. It also brought together and gave direction to railway matters that had hitherto remained scattered and dealt with in isolation. A direct result of these recommendations was a centralized railway system in India by the end of the second decade of the 20th century.